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गृह मंत्रालय/Ministry of Home Affairs

भारत के महारजिस्ट्रार एवं जनगणना आयुक्त का कार्यालय

Office of the Registrar General & Census Commissioner, India

जनगणना प्रभाग/Census Division

Janganana Bhawan, 2/A Mansingh Road,
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Date: 09th February 2026

CENSUS OF INDIA 2027 - CIRCULAR No. 10

Subject: Guidelines for formation and allocation of Houselisting Blocks, generation of Appointment orders and ID cards for Enumerators/Supervisors and House numbering during Houselisting Operation.

The Houselisting Operations (HLO) is scheduled to be conducted in a period of 30 days during April – September, 2026 in different States and Union Territories (UTs). Notification in this regard has already been issued by the Government of India on 07.01.2026. States/UTs have been requested to republish the notification mentioning exact date of HLO in their States/UTs.

2. Boundaries of all administrative units have been frozen on 01.01.2026 and the list of Districts/Sub-districts/Towns/Villages/Wards have been prepared in consultation with the States/UTs. Village and Wards are the lowest administrative units in Rural and Urban areas respectively. It is necessary to ensure that the enumerators who undertake the Houselisting Operations (HLO) have a reasonable and as far as possible an equitable workload. This is achieved through the important step of constituting blocks for Houselisting purposes. The word "block" means a well-defined area in a village or in a ward of the town which can be clearly demarcated on the ground and for which a map is drawn for the purpose of the Census Operations. Such blocks created for HLO and Population Enumeration (PE) are called Houselisting Blocks (HLBs) and Enumeration Blocks (EBs) respectively. The HLBs/EBs would ultimately be the smallest administrative unit for conducting

Census and would form the basis for processing of data after the field operations are over.

3. An HLB is to be created in accordance with the criteria of 700-800 population for residential areas. In sparsely populated non-residential areas one HLB may be formed by taking 300 or more Census Houses. It may be mentioned that a 'Census House' is a Building or part of a Building used or recognized as a separate unit because of having a separate main entrance from the road or common courtyard or staircase etc. A clear demarcation of blocks for Houselisting purposes cannot be undertaken with certainty as the exact current population size is not available. Based on the local knowledge and circumstances, the Census Charge Officers may make an assessment/estimate of present population and delineate HLBs based on criterion given above. It may so happen that the habitation pattern and geo-graphical situation do not allow creation of HLBs as per the mentioned population or Census house criteria. In such cases, HLBs of smaller size may be constituted but more than one HLB may be allotted to one enumerator so that workload of enumerators is not disproportionate. Some of the other broad principles which may be kept in mind while carving out the HLBs are discussed in the following paragraphs:

Rural Area

4. The Revenue Village is the basic unit in rural area in Census operations. Special care should be taken to ensure that all the constituent Habitations of the Revenue Village are fully covered while forming HLBs. At least one HLB is to be formed in a village irrespective of its population. There may be cases where the population of the Revenue Village is very small or even zero (uninhabited). Each of such villages must be constituted into separate HLB. Under no circumstance, one HLB is to be formed taking parts of two villages. It should however be ensured that separate account is
maintained for each of the HLBs assigned to the enumerator.

5. If a village has a large population, exceeding the normal workload of an enumerator, it may be split into multiple HLBs. In such cases, permanent physical features such as major roads, canals, rivers, railway lines or other prominent natural or man-made features etc. to be taken as the boundaries of the HLBs for clear-cut identification. Each such block should be assigned to a separate enumerator. Once the HLB has been constituted, the enumerator should have a clear idea of the geographical boundaries of the block (or blocks) assigned to him/her for HLO.

6. In some cases, it has been noticed that parts of a village are spread over two or more Village Panchayats/Village Councils etc. While carving out the HLBs in such villages, it may be kept in mind that boundary of the Panchayats also are to be kept intact to the extent possible. If any village is spreading over more than one Gram Panchayat, then separate HLB(s) is to be formed for the part of the village falling in one Gram Panchayat and separate HLB(s) in other Gram Panchayat. If it so happens, that the population of the HLBs thus formed are low, then both the HLBs may be allotted to the same enumerator. But, it should be ensured that separate account is maintained for each of the HLBs assigned. Likewise, it is to be ensured by the Charge Officer that no HLB is formed cutting across the sub-district boundary. If any village is spreading over more than one sub-district, then separate HLB(s) is to be formed for the part of the village falling in one sub-district and separate HLB(s) in other sub-district. All the HLBs should have clear-cut boundaries. There may be isolated habitations in Agricultural land of a village which are not included in the main village. Care should be taken to include these habitations in one of the neighboring HLBs based on geographical proximity.

7. In forest areas, there may be habitations, which may not fall within the area of any Revenue Village. In such cases, an HLB should be constituted on the basis of the settlement pattern and the smallest forest administrative unit. Details of such areas will have to be obtained from the District Forest Officer or her/his subordinate officer. Further, if any habitation is found located outside the jurisdiction of the Revenue Villages but does not fall under any Forest Village either, such habitation shall be mandatorily attached to the nearest Revenue or Forest Village, based on geographical proximity and administrative convenience to ensure complete coverage.

Urban Areas

8. Ward is the basic unit in towns or urban area in Census operations. The same criteria of 700-800 population for residential areas are to be adopted for urban areas also in carving HLBs. In sparsely populated non-residential areas one HLB may be formed by taking 300 or more Census Houses. It is again to be ensured that HLBs in urban areas should not cut across Municipal divisions or wards and clearly identifiable prominent natural or man-made features such as major roads, canals, rivers, railway lines etc. In rare cases it may happen that a town is falling under two or more sub-districts or even a ward of a town is falling under two sub-districts. In such cases much care is needed to affirm that HLB boundaries do not cut across sub-district boundaries.

Supervisory Circle

9. Six or more contiguous HLBs, which are to be allotted to six enumerators, will constitute a Supervisory Circle (SC) for which a Supervisor is to be appointed. In rural areas, these HLBs can be part of one village or multiple villages but these HLBs should be contiguous. Similarly, in urban areas these HLBs may be part of one ward or multiple wards but the HLBs should be contiguous. An enumerator can have HLB(s) within one Supervisory Circle only.

Sample Registration System (SRS) Units

10. In both rural and urban areas, the outer boundaries of Sample Registration System (SRS) units shall remain undisturbed. Accordingly, in certain cases, the prescribed norm of 700–800 population may be exceeded, and such deviations shall be treated as justified exceptions. However, where the workload within an SRS unit is exceptionally high, more than one HLB may be constituted, strictly within the boundaries of the same SRS unit, without including any area from outside. In urban areas, one SRS unit consists of a single Enumeration Block (EB) of Census 2011. In rural areas, an SRS unit comprises an entire village or part of a village and may consist of one or more Census 2011 EBs. In the formation of HLBs for SRS units in urban areas, more than one HLB may be created in accordance with the present population criteria. However, in rural areas, while the boundary of the entire SRS unit shall not be cut across, the boundaries of individual Census 2011 EBs may be reorganized for the formation of HLBs as per the present population criteria. The boundaries of SRS units are clearly indicated in the Village and Ward level working maps supplied for
field use and reference.

HLBs in Slum Area

11. While forming the HLBs in statutory towns, the identity of the slum areas is to be kept intact as explained in great details in *Circular No. 6* dated 04.12.2025 on the subject. It is to be ensured that areas classified as Slum and Non-Slum are not combined within a single HLB under any circumstances. Since the processing of Slum-level data for urban areas is critically dependent on this segregation, Charge Officers should strictly adhere to this norm.

Houselisting Block Numbering

12. Each village and town will, thus, comprise one or more houselisting blocks (HLBs). The HLBs created for the Census 2027 within a Charge, whether rural or urban, will bear a continuous four digited serial number like 0001, 0002, 0003,.....and so on. If a City or Town contains more than one Charge, the HLBs will be numbered continuously within each Charge. In case of the Rural Charge, HLBs will be numbered continuously as per the ascending order of the Village Location Code numbers. In case of Urban Charge, HLBs will be numbered continuously as per the ascending order of the ward numbers.

House Numbering

13. In areas where systematic house numbering exists, enumerators may use the same for the purpose of assigning building numbers. Where the same does not exist, the enumerator is to provide building number with the number of Census houses in it put in bracket by permanent marker pens prefixed by CN or any equivalent in the vernacular language (to indicate Census numbers). The size of the number should be such that it can be easily seen from a distance of two meters and be written at a prominent place such as the door way or adjacent to it. These building numbers as well as the number of Census houses in it to be also shown in the lay-out map prepared by the enumerator. At the time of house to house field data collection, the Census House numbers generated in HLO app will be written at a prominent place such as the door way or adjacent to it for each Census House. The same is elaborated in "***Instruction Manual for Houselisting and Housing Census***" for Census 2027.

14. In both rural and urban areas, it should be made absolutely clear that the numbers given during Census does not confer any right of regularization. It is only for facilitating the Census work.

Creation of HLBs, Supervisory Circles (SC), demarcation and allocation through Census Monitoring and Management System (CMMS) portal and its interface with HLB Creator (HLBC) Web Mapping Application.

15. For the first time, the creation and demarcation of HLBs, formation of **SC** and allocation of enumerators and supervisors for the HLBs and SCs will be carried out through the Census Monitoring and Management System (CMMS) portal and HLB

Creator (HLBC) Web Mapping Application respectively. The activities required to be carried out by the Charge Officer are given below:

I. Preparation of HLB list

i) Through the *Create/View HLBs* sub module of HLO management module in CMMS, list of Villages/Census Towns and the list of urban Wards along with the location particulars will be available for Rural and Urban Charges respectively.

ii) Name of the Hamlets, Estimated Present Population and Number of Panchayats/Village Council for each Village/Census Towns are to be entered by rural Charge officer in the *Create/View HLBs* sub module using add option. Based on the estimated present population and no. of panchayats, number of HLBs to be formed in each Village/Census Town are to be entered. For Urban charge, Charge officer will enter the Locality/Mohalla/Colony name and estimated present population of each urban ward. Based on the estimated present population, number of HLBs to be formed for each ward will be entered. The number of HLBs formed for both Rural and Urban charges will be arrived as per the norms detailed in preceding para. It is reiterated that the number of HLBs may be decided pragmatically based on understanding of the ground level situation and discussion with local knowledgeable persons like village/ward officials, patwaris etc. Also, it may be noted that since HLB boundary should not cut across panchayat boundaries to the extent possible, the number of HLBs to be formed in a village should at least be equal to the number of panchayats in which the village fall.

iii) As per the number of HLBs entered, HLB numbers for each Village/Census Town and Ward will be auto-generated in *Create/View HLBs* sub module.

iv) Once the HLB list is finalized, the same is to be frozen by clicking *freeze* option. Care is to be taken before freezing the village/ward wise final number of HLBs as after freezing the number of HLBs cannot be reduced and the auto-generated HLB numbers would become permanent. The Charge officer, however, may increase the number of HLBs in a village/ward afterwards, in which case the HLB number will be generated as the next number of the last HLB number of the Charge, generated before freezing.

II. Workflow for HLB Geo-tagging / Demarcation in HLBC

i) **Access to HLBC after HLB Finalization in CMMS**: Upon completion of finalization and freezing of HLBs in CMMS, the finalized HLB list will be displayed and the HLB *Mapping link* will be activated. The Charge Officer will access the HLBC application through OTP-based authentication on the registered mobile number. Using the Map Module in HLBC, the Charge Officer shall select HLBs sequentially, geo-tag prominent landmarks, and demarcate the boundary covering the intended HLB area.

ii) **Use of Working Maps for field inputs:** Physical copies of geo-referenced maps as working map of Charges and Villages/Wards in it will be available to the Charge Officer. For obtaining inputs from field-level functionaries such as Village/Ward officials, Patwaris, and other local authorities, these Working Maps of Villages (Rural) and Wards (Urban) shall be utilized. It must be ensured that;

1. No part of any Village/Ward remains uncovered in an HLB; and
2. There is no overlap between HLBs.

This is critical to prevent omission or duplication of coverage.

iii) **Use of Administrative boundary layers and Map Repository**: Digital boundary layers of administrative units (District, Sub-district, Village, Town, Ward, etc.) will be available as digital layers within HLBC and also in *Map Repository* Module of CMMS Portal in the form of downloadable pdfs. The Charge Officers shall use these for ensuring completeness of HLB coverage and ensure that there is no left-out area between the HLBs created in her/his jurisdiction. In charges where the number of HLBs are high and demarcation of HLBs in HLBC is difficult for a single user in the given time period, multiple users can be created in the HLBC to facilitate parallel work. If, during the HLB carving through HLBC, the Charge officer feels the need to increase the number of HLB(s) in a village/ward, s/he has to switch to CMMS wherein s/he can increase the same in *Create/View HLBs* sub module through *Add HLBs* option in the *Actions* column. Newly added HLBs will be numbered sequentially following the last HLB number already generated for the Charge.

iv) **Special instructions for SRS Units**: In the case of SRS units, the SRS boundary layer shall be enabled from the Layer List and used as a mandatory reference during geo-tagging and HLB demarcation. HLBs shall be formed strictly within SRS unit boundaries without merging with the adjoining areas.

v) **Completion and Map Generation:** Mark each HLB as completed after proper demarcation and geo-tagging. This process indicates readiness for generation of HLB Maps. The generated HLB maps will be available with the Appointment Letter on the next day and also will be made available through HLO App for the supervisors and enumerators.

vi) **Role in Self-Enumeration Mapping**: The finalized and demarcated HLB boundaries shall be used for assigning Self-Enumerated households to the respective Enumerators, ensuring verification at the time of field visit during HLO.

III. Once the work in HLBC is over, switch back to CMMS, assign HLB Type in the *Assign HLB Type* sub module for Urban Charges. This is not applicable for Rural Charges. HLB type can be one of the four, namely, *Notified slum-1, Recognized slum-2, Identified slum-3 and Non-slum-4*. As already stated at para 11 above, ensure that slum HLBs are not clubbed with the neighbouring non-slum HLBs. Option for modifying the assigned HLB type is also available in the *Modify Assigned HLB Type* sub module.

IV. After that clear location description must be provided for each HLB in the *HLB Description* sub-module. The description will consist of the boundary and neighbourhood of the HLB along with the road/street/lane names, locality and prominent landmarks etc. to facilitate identification of the HLB by the concerned enumerator and supervisor to whom it will be allotted and attached with their Appointment Letter.

V. In certain cases, during the initial phase of fieldwork—while enumerators and/or supervisors are doing ground truthing and preparing the layout map—it may be noticed that there arises necessity for creation of additional HLBs or the boundaries of existing HLBs delineated by the Charge officer require modification. In case additional HLB(s) are to be created, the Charge officer have to create the additional HLB(s) in CMMS first through *Add HLB* option and only then mark the boundaries for the same in the HLBC web app. Whereas, in case changes in existing boundary of the already carved HLBs are required, the same may be done directly in HLBC. In both the cases, an SMS will go to the concerned enumerator and supervisor. They need to refresh the HLO app after 24 hours to get the updated downloadable pdf copy of the HLB(s) map. The SE IDs mapped to the HLB will also get refreshed as per the updated boundary.

VI. Supervisory Circles shall be constituted in the *Supervisory Circle Creation* sub module by grouping six or more geographically contiguous HLBs. These HLBs can be part of one Village/Ward or multiple Villages/Wards. The system will display the list of frozen HLBs for selection for formation of Supervisory Circles. Once the SC is created by selecting the required HLBs in CMMS, the SC maps will be auto generated and made available for use by next day through CMMS - *Map Repository*. Provision for reallocating HLBs from one supervisory circle to another is also available in the *Supervisory Circle Creation* sub module.

VII. Once the Supervisory Circle is created, the allocation of each Supervisory Circle to specific Supervisors created through *User Management* module of CMMS is to be done in *Supervisory Circle Allocation* sub module. Option to revoke Supervisory Circle from a supervisor is also available in *Supervisory Circle Revocation* sub module. Subsequently, in the *HLB Allocation* sub module, enumerators are to be allocated to HLBs. One enumerator may be assigned multiple HLBs also to ensure equal work load to all enumerators but only within the same Supervisory Circle. An option for revoking HLB(s) from enumerators is also available in the *HLB Revocation* sub module.

VIII. Guidelines on numbering of HLBs has already been communicated through Census *Circular No. 8* dated 09.01.2026 namely "Assigning Location/Short Code numbers at various Administrative levels".

IX. Ensure that all area or habitation is covered under the HLBs created except for areas under jurisdiction of military/paramilitary establishments in which, like previous Census, Houselisting Operations will not be carried out.

X. Once all the above steps are over the training batches for E&S are to be formed and E&S are to be nominated in batches created in the *Training Management* module. Subsequently, Charge officers are to download the Appointment Letters and ID cards for supervisors and enumerators from the *Supervisor Appointment Letter and ID card generation* and *Enumerator Appointment Letter and ID card generation* sub modules respectively. The Appointment letters to be printed at Charge office, signed with seal of Charge officer and issue after verifying that the location particulars and description of HLB(s) (for enumerator) and particulars of enumerators (for supervisor) are attached to it alongwith geo-referenced map of HLB(s) or SC as the case may be. The ID cards are also to be printed at Charge Office

(size A6, i.e. 4.1 × 5.8 inches/ 10.5X14.8 cms) in 300 GSM art card paper and issued with the signature of Charge officer, after filling in the validity period and affixing photograph cross signed and stamped on it by the Charge Officer.

16. The concerned Charge Officers shall adhere to the illustrative timelines given below while undertaking the carving of HLBs for Census 2027. For the purpose of clarity, if the field work for HLO commences at Time 'T' in a particular State/UT, then the following timelines shall apply.

Sl. No.	**Task to be completed**	**Timeline (Week(s))**	**If T is 16th April, 2026**
1	Availability of Location Master along with geo-referenced village/ ward/charge maps to Charge Officers	T-9	2nd Week of February
2	Finalisation and Freezing of HLB numbers	T-9 to T-8	2nd to 3rd Week of February
3	On-boarding of required number of Enumerators and Supervisors (including reserve) in CMMS Portal	T-8 to T-7	3rd to 4th Week of February
4	Carving out of HLB boundaries in the HLBC Web Mapping Application, assigning HLB type and providing description in CMMS	T-8 to T-6	3rd Week of Feb to 1st Week of March
5	Supervisory Circle creation, allocation of SCs and HLBs to Supervisors and Enumerators	T-6 to T-5	1st - 2nd Week of March
6	Training batch creation and nomination of E&S, Generation of Appointment letters and ID Card	T-5	2nd Week of March

17. The highlights of the guidelines for formation of Houselisting blocks are recapitulated below:

i) The ideal size of the Houselisting block is 700-800 population for residential areas. In sparsely populated non-residential areas one HLB may be formed by taking 300 or more Census Houses.

ii) Each village, irrespective of its population, including uninhabited villages will have at least one HLB.

iii) The boundaries of each HLB should be clearly demarcated and identified. Also, the same need to be meticulously described.

iv) In rural areas, HLBs should not cut across village, Gram panchayat, sub-district boundaries.

v) In urban areas, HLBs should not cut across wards, town or city, sub-district boundaries.

vi) In both rural and urban areas, the outer boundaries of Sample Registration system (SRS) units shall remain intact.

vii) In all statutory towns irrespective of their population size, slum blocks must be demarcated separately. The HLB should not be created taking portions of slum and non-slum areas.

viii) One enumerator can be given work of more than one HLB in case of small size HLBs, but only within the same Supervisory Circle.

ix) One Supervisory Circle will generally contain HLBs allotted to 6 or more Enumerators

x) HLB boundaries and Supervisory Circles need to be accurately delineated, which are spatially contiguous and mutually exclusive with no gaps or overlaps.

xi) Habitations outside revenue villages, forest villages, urban areas etc. may be taken special care for inclusion

xii) Digital tools like CMMS, HLBC, HLO App etc. need to be used by maintaining proper sequence of activities to facilitate smooth flow of work.

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09/02/2026

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